

THE WAY

Native Religious Lexicon & Naming Architecture

Way → Companions → Assembly → Houses of Prayer

Version 0.5 | September 19, 2026

Working language for UNDECIDED

Purpose

Develop a native religious vocabulary that grows from ordinary contemporary English, is historically informed without imitating ancient languages, supports a globally translatable movement, and reinforces the project's anti-coercion constitutional architecture.

1. Executive conclusion

The four terms already selected form a coherent religious grammar. They should be treated not as competing names but as four layers of one identity system:

Layer	Native term	Meaning	Natural sentence
Path / tradition	the Way	The religious way of life	“We seek to walk the Way.”
Person / adherent	a Companion	One who walks with others	“She is a Companion of the Way.”
Whole community	the Assembly	The gathered religious community	“The Assembly gathers for prayer and discernment.”
Local community / place	a House of Prayer	A local congregation and its place of gathering	“They gather at the House of Prayer.”

Working identity formula

The Way is walked by Companions, who together form the Assembly and gather locally in Houses of Prayer. The fuller ceremonial expression “House of Prayer for All Peoples” may carry the inclusive scriptural vision behind the local institution.

2. Why this structure is historically natural

The vocabulary is not arbitrary. Comparable religious movements repeatedly developed ordinary-language words for path, people, gathered community, and place before later generations produced abstract “-ism” names. The parallels below are semantic analogies, not claims that the traditions are equivalent.

Concept	Jewish / biblical	Early Christian	Islamic / Sufi	Buddhist / Sikh	Quaker
Way / path	derekh (“way”)	hodos; “the Way” in Acts	ṭarīqah: road/path and Sufi spiritual way	mārga/magga: path; panth: way/path and community	“way opens” as living idiom
Companionship	covenant/fellow people rather than one exact cognate	disciples, brothers/sisters, saints	Ṣaḥāba: Muhammad’s Companions (specific historical category)	spiritual friendship exists in many schools; sangat emphasizes company/congregation	Friends

Concept	Jewish / biblical	Early Christian	Islamic / Sufi	Buddhist / Sikh	Quaker
Assembly / community	qahal / edah	ekklesia	umma	saṅgha; Sikh sangat	Meeting
Local sacred place	synagogue / house of assembly and prayer traditions	ekklesia later associated with church buildings	masjid	gurdwara; vihara	meetinghouse

“The Way” is especially strong because path-language appears independently across multiple traditions.

Cambridge scholar Paul Trebilco notes that Greek hodos can mean road, journey, or way of life and argues that “the Way” functions as a group self-designation in Acts. Arabic ṭarīqah literally means road/path and became a term for a Sufi spiritual path; Buddhist mārga/magga designates a path of practice; and the SGPC describes Sikh panth as literally “the way” or a good way of life. [S1–S4]

“Assembly” likewise has deep roots without belonging exclusively to one lineage. Biblical qahal can denote the assembly/community of Israel, and Greek ekklesia originally meant an assembly and became the dominant early Christian community term. Comparable community terms include Islamic umma, Buddhist saṅgha, Sikh sangat, and Quaker Meeting. [S5–S9]

“Companion” adds an unusually suitable horizontal image. In Islam, Ṣaḥāba is the specific historical term for Muhammad’s Companions, so that resonance must be acknowledged rather than blurred. In English, however, “companion” has its own history: the word derives through French from Late/Vulgar Latin forms built from “with” + “bread,” hence the traditional etymological sense of a bread-sharing fellow. [S10–S11]

“House of Prayer for All Peoples” comes directly from Isaiah 56:7, where the emphasis is that the house of prayer is for all peoples. That makes it especially apt as a ceremonial or theological expansion of the ordinary local term “House of Prayer.” [S12]

3. Four language registers

A mature tradition should not force one vocabulary to do four different jobs. The same institution can speak devotionally, communally, academically, and legally without confusing those registers.

Register	Purpose	Preferred language	Example
Devotional	Prayer, worship, spiritual practice	God / Divine language as theology develops; prayer; worship; remembrance	“The House gathers for prayer.”
Communal	Identity and belonging	Way, Companion, Assembly, House of Prayer, Gathering	“Companions gathered with the Assembly.”
Research	Historical and phenomenological inquiry	transcendent reality, encounter, testimony, evidence, interpretation,	“The source reports an encounter later interpreted as

Register	Purpose	Preferred language	Example
		hypothesis	revelation.”
Legal / corporate	Civil governance and compliance	corporation, Board of Directors, officer, policy, employee, statutory member	“The Board adopted the safeguarding policy.”

Critical separation

“Companion” is a religious identity, not automatically a statutory corporate member. “The Assembly” is the religious community, not the nonprofit Board. A “House of Prayer” is a local religious community, not automatically a separate corporation. These distinctions should be explicit in bylaws and public materials.

4. Native lexicon v0.5

Status labels: ADOPT = recommended native usage now; PROVISIONAL/CANDIDATE = useful but not yet constitutionalized; RESERVED = hold until theology or practice justifies it; CONTEXTUAL/EXTERNAL = use only in the stated context; AVOID = do not make part of the movement’s official identity system.

Core identity

Term	Status	Working meaning	Usage / safeguard
The Way	ADOPT	The religious path or way of life itself; the tradition as something practiced rather than merely subscribed to.	walk the Way; learn the Way; teachings of the Way Use as sacred/native vocabulary, not necessarily as the standalone legal or trademark brand because existing organizations use the phrase.
Companion	ADOPT	A person who freely undertakes to walk the Way with others. The term is intentionally lateral rather than follower-centered.	a Companion; Companion of the Way; become a Companion Religious identity only. It does not by itself create statutory corporate membership or voting rights.
Companions	ADOPT	The people collectively	the Companions;

Term	Status	Working meaning	Usage / safeguard
		who identify as Companions.	Companions of the Way Do not use to imply a spiritual caste or automatic authority.
The Assembly	ADOPT	The whole gathered religious community of Companions and welcome participants.	the Assembly gathers; life of the Assembly Capital A refers to the religious community. It is distinct from the legal corporation and Board of Directors.
House of Prayer	ADOPT	A local expression of the Assembly: a congregation and, by extension, the place where it gathers for prayer, study, fellowship, and service.	a House of Prayer; the House of Prayer at [place] Need not own a building. A House of Prayer is not a separate legal entity unless explicitly organized as one.
House of Prayer for All Peoples	ADOPT - CEREMONIAL	The fuller theological expression behind the local term, drawing on Isaiah 56:7 and its inclusive vision.	mission statement; dedication language; ceremonial use Use carefully as a scriptural inheritance, not as a claim that the movement owns the phrase.
Gathering	ADOPT	A particular meeting of the Assembly or a House of Prayer.	Gathering for Prayer; Gathering for Study; Gathering for Service Preferred over using “service” for every meeting because service also means charitable action.
walking the Way	ADOPT	Ordinary idiom for practicing the religion or participating in its way of life.	She walks the Way; we walk together Should never imply that departure makes a person

Term	Status	Working meaning	Usage / safeguard
			an enemy or traitor.

Knowledge & revelation

Term	Status	Working meaning	Usage / safeguard
Encounter	ADOPT	A reported or experienced event interpreted as contact with, disclosure from, or awareness of transcendent reality.	reported encounter; encounter record Phenomenological term: it describes the claim/event without automatically validating its interpretation.
Testimony	ADOPT	A person's or community's account of an encounter, conviction, event, or practice.	testimony of a Companion; historical testimony Testimony is evidence to consider, not an automatic command.
Witness	ADOPT	A person, text, artifact, practice, or other source that bears evidence concerning an encounter, event, belief, or tradition.	historical witness; textual witness Do not confuse "witness" with proof of every theological interpretation attached to it.
Revelation	TECHNICAL / PROVISIONAL	A claimed disclosure from God/the Divine/transcendent reality.	claimed revelation; revelation tradition A revelation claim never bypasses consent, safeguarding, law, financial controls, or governance.
Interpretation	ADOPT	The human act of assigning meaning to an encounter, revelation claim, text, event, or tradition.	interpretation of testimony; competing interpretations Must remain distinguishable from the underlying evidence or claim.

Term	Status	Working meaning	Usage / safeguard
Teaching	ADOPT	A proposition or practice currently taught by the Assembly.	a teaching of the Assembly; current teaching Teachings may carry stated confidence levels and can be revised through discernment.
Doctrine	RESERVED / FORMAL	A teaching formally adopted with defined status and implications.	formal doctrine Use sparingly. Do not let informal opinion become doctrine by repetition.
Tradition	ADOPT	An inherited body of practices, stories, interpretations, texts, customs, and collective memory.	the Christian tradition; the Assembly's developing tradition Tradition is not identical with revelation or infallibility.
Sacred Sources	PROVISIONAL	Umbrella term for texts, oral traditions, artifacts, practices, and records treated as spiritually significant in the traditions being studied.	study of Sacred Sources Does not declare all sources equally authoritative or create a canon.
Scripture	CONTEXTUAL	A text regarded as scripture within a particular religious tradition or, later, by the Assembly if explicitly adopted.	Jewish scripture; Islamic scripture; Buddhist scriptures Do not retroactively label every sacred source "our scripture."
Canon	RESERVED	A formally bounded collection of authoritative texts.	canon of a source tradition No Assembly canon should be presumed before a separate theological/canonical process.
Inquiry	ADOPT	Disciplined investigation of religious, historical, philosophical, and	sacred inquiry; historical inquiry

Term	Status	Working meaning	Usage / safeguard
		experiential claims.	Inquiry is not a substitute for worship, but neither may worship shut inquiry down.
Discernment	ADOPT	A communal and individual process of testing claims, choices, motives, and proposed actions.	discernment meeting; discern a teaching Discernment does not authorize coercion and is not a magic word for leadership preference.

Devotion & practice

Term	Status	Working meaning	Usage / safeguard
Prayer	ADOPT	Intentional address, attention, petition, thanksgiving, lament, praise, silence, or communion directed toward God/the Divine as understood by the person or community.	Gathering for Prayer; daily prayer Specific forms remain to be developed; no one prayer form should be assumed universal yet.
Worship	ADOPT	Communal or personal acts oriented toward reverence of God/the Divine or the sacred.	public worship; worship gathering Theological scope remains open enough for the movement's eventual doctrine of God/transcendence.
Study	ADOPT	Serious learning from sacred sources, history, languages, scholarship, and lived traditions.	Gathering for Study; study group Study should include primary sources, scholarship, and competing interpretations.
Service	ADOPT	Voluntary action for the good of other people, communities, creatures, or the world.	Gathering for Service; service project Never condition

Term	Status	Working meaning	Usage / safeguard
			charitable service on conversion, loyalty, silence, or membership.
Offering	ADOPT	A voluntary gift of money, goods, time, skill, or service.	make an offering; freewill offering No offering purchases spiritual status, office, protection, revelation, or preferential treatment.
Retreat	ADOPT	A temporary period of intensified prayer, study, silence, fellowship, or reflection.	weekend retreat; retreat house Participation must remain voluntary; do not use deprivation or isolation as control techniques.
Remembrance	PROVISIONAL	Intentional recalling of God/the Divine, sacred history, persons, events, teachings, or obligations.	a practice of remembrance Broadly resonant across traditions; specific ritual meaning should await theology.
The Common Table	CANDIDATE	A possible name for a shared communal meal expressing equality, hospitality, and companionship.	gather at the Common Table Not yet adopted as a rite. The name becomes especially meaningful because “companion” historically carries the sense of one who shares bread.
Rule of Life	PROVISIONAL	A written pattern of common practices and ethical commitments freely undertaken.	personal Rule of Life; common Rule of Life Must not become a coercive surveillance code. Participation and consequences require due process and conscience protections.

Leadership & ministry

Term	Status	Working meaning	Usage / safeguard
Founder	ADOPT - HISTORICAL ONLY	The person who originated the present institutional project.	Founder of the organization Carries no inherent spiritual supremacy, veto, succession right, doctrinal infallibility, or special disciplinary immunity.
Minister	PROVISIONAL	A person formally entrusted with defined functions of prayer, pastoral care, worship, teaching, rites, or service.	commissioned Minister; ministry team Should be an accountable function, not a sacred caste. Exact ordination/commissioning theology remains open.
Teacher	ADOPT	A person recognized or assigned to teach within an area of demonstrated competence.	Teacher of history; Teacher in a House of Prayer Teaching authority is subject to sources, review, correction, and scope of competence.
Steward	ADOPT	A person entrusted with resources, operations, property, administration, or a defined communal responsibility.	House Steward; Steward of Finance Stewardship means custody on behalf of others, not ownership or spiritual rank.
Elder	PROVISIONAL	A possible term for a person recognized for maturity, wisdom, long service, and sound judgment.	an Elder of the Assembly If adopted, it should confer no automatic executive, financial, or revelatory authority.
Council	PROVISIONAL	A deliberative body convened for a defined spiritual, ethical, or communal purpose.	Council of the Assembly; Council of Houses Corporate powers remain with legally defined bodies. Council

Term	Status	Working meaning	Usage / safeguard
			jurisdiction must be written and limited.
Commissioning	ADOPT - PROCESS	Formal authorization of a person for a defined ministry or service.	commissioning a Minister; letter of commissioning Preferred working term before a theology of ordination is settled; authorization is revocable through due process.
Ordination	RESERVED	A possible future religious act establishing an ordained ministry if theology and practice warrant it.	ordination rite Do not create merely to imitate established religions or to manufacture tax status.
Clergy	EXTERNAL / LEGAL UMBRELLA	General external term for recognized religious ministers where law, institutions, or public communication require it.	clergy housing rules; clergy credentialing Not necessarily the preferred internal self-description.

Community & governance

Term	Status	Working meaning	Usage / safeguard
Board of Directors	ADOPT - LEGAL	The governing board of the nonprofit corporation under civil law.	Board resolution; Board Chair Legally distinct from the Assembly, Companions, ministers, and any religious Council.
Council of the Assembly	CANDIDATE	A possible future religious deliberative body for doctrine, practice, or communal discernment.	refer a question to the Council Must not be allowed to swallow the Board's fiduciary duties or participant rights.
Council of Houses	CANDIDATE	A possible representative body linking multiple	annual Council of Houses

Term	Status	Working meaning	Usage / safeguard
		Houses of Prayer.	Only meaningful after multiple local Houses actually exist.
Regional Assembly	PROVISIONAL	A gathering or coordinating body of multiple Houses of Prayer within a geographic region.	Appalachian Regional Assembly Avoid creating jurisdictional hierarchy before it is operationally needed.
Companion Commitment	CANDIDATE	A possible voluntary statement by which an adult publicly identifies as a Companion.	make the Companion Commitment Should affirm rights of conscience and exit; never an irrevocable vow.

Place & institution

Term	Status	Working meaning	Usage / safeguard
Institute for Sacred Inquiry	CANDIDATE	A possible name for the research, historical, linguistic, and comparative-religion function of the wider project.	research conducted by the Institute Useful because “inquiry” fits the scholarly arm better than the entire religion.
House of Study	CANDIDATE	A functional educational space or program devoted to serious study.	House of Study program English phrase is usable, but it strongly echoes Jewish beit midrash; adopt only intentionally.
Retreat House	FUNCTIONAL	A place used for voluntary retreats, prayer, study, and rest.	Assembly Retreat House Residential safeguarding, access, and exit protections apply.

Reserved / avoid as offices

Term	Status	Working meaning	Usage / safeguard
Prophet	NOT AN OFFICE	A descriptive historical/theological category for a person claimed to speak through divine revelation.	study of prophets; a person claims prophetic experience No person becomes institutionally unquestionable by claiming the title.
Master	AVOID AS TITLE	A title implying personal spiritual domination or superior status.	- Incompatible with the lateral Companion model.
Guru / Shaykh / Rabbi / Imam / Priest	TRADITION-SPECIFIC	Established titles belonging to particular living traditions and role systems.	use when referring to those traditions Do not borrow merely for exotic effect. The Assembly should develop honest English offices from its own functions.

Reserved / avoid as labels

Term	Status	Working meaning	Usage / safeguard
Apostate / heretic / unbeliever	AVOID AS ADMINISTRATIVE LABEL	Traditional polemical or theological categories.	- Never use as organizational categories for former participants, critics, or people who disagree.
Follower of the Founder	AVOID	Founder-centered identity formula.	- The movement is organized around the Way, not personal allegiance to its founder.

5. Naming God / transcendent reality: do not force the decision early

The core identity vocabulary can mature before the movement settles every metaphysical question. Because the project studies Abrahamic, Dharmic, mystical, philosophical, and other traditions, one divine title should not be made a hidden doctrinal shortcut.

Context	Working expression	Reason
Devotional	God; additional names/titles as theology develops	Natural English prayer language without pretending all traditions mean the same thing.
Cross-tradition dialogue	the Divine; ultimate reality, where context requires	Flexible comparative language.
Research / phenomenology	transcendent reality; claimed transcendent encounter	Describes reports without deciding the theological interpretation in advance.

Recommendation

Do not select a proprietary new name for God merely to make the movement distinctive. Let divine naming emerge from the theological work and from actual prayer, while maintaining the encounter → testimony → interpretation distinction already embedded in the integrity framework.

6. How the language should sound in real life

A successful native vocabulary needs ordinary grammar. The following sentences are deliberately plain enough that people could actually say them without sounding as though they had joined a role-playing world.

- I try to walk the Way.
- I am a Companion of the Way — usually just “a Companion.”
- The Companions gather as the Assembly.
- Our local community is a House of Prayer.
- The House of Prayer meets in a rented room; “House” describes the community and function, not real-estate ownership.
- We have a Gathering for Prayer on Friday evening and a Gathering for Study on Sunday afternoon.
- The Assembly is studying several testimonies and competing interpretations before adopting a teaching.
- She is a Teacher in the House, but that does not make her an unquestionable authority.
- He was commissioned as a Minister for pastoral care.
- The Board governs the nonprofit corporation; the Assembly is the religious community.
- She no longer identifies as a Companion. She remains welcome at public gatherings.

7. Capitalization and style rules

- Capitalize The Way, Companion(s), The Assembly, and House of Prayer when they are used as defined proper terms of this tradition; use lowercase when the words have ordinary meanings.
- Prefer “Companion of the Way” in formal explanatory writing and “Companion” in ordinary speech.
- Use “the Assembly” for the worldwide or general religious community. Use “an assembly” or “a gathering” for a particular meeting unless a local body has a formal proper name.
- Use “House of Prayer at [Place]” when a place name would otherwise make the phrase sound like a property title. Example: “House of Prayer at Knoxville.” A later naming review can decide whether “Knoxville House of Prayer” is appropriate and clearable.
- Do not capitalize founder titles into quasi-sacred honorifics. “founder” and “President/Executive Director” describe roles, not spiritual rank.
- Do not use insider/outsider labels that turn disagreement or departure into a moral identity category.

8. Translation philosophy for a global movement

The movement should not accidentally create English as a sacred language. The vocabulary is best understood as a semantic system: local communities should use natural equivalents in their own languages, developed with competent native speakers and reviewed for theological drift.

- Translate meaning before sound. Do not require transliteration of “Way,” “Companion,” or “Assembly” into English everywhere.
- Do not automatically import Hebrew, Greek, Arabic, Sanskrit, Pali, Punjabi, Persian, or Latin vocabulary simply because it sounds ancient or sacred.
- When a source-tradition term is used in teaching — qahal, ekklesia, umma, saṅgha, sangat, ṭarīqah, panth, mārga — identify it as that tradition’s own word and explain its context.
- Maintain a controlled translation glossary once multilingual Houses of Prayer exist. Translation should preserve rights language as carefully as devotional language.

9. Anti-coercion language constitution

Language shapes institutions. The lexicon should therefore make certain power relationships difficult to normalize.

Prefer	Instead of	Why
Companion	follower of [leader]	Centers lateral companionship rather than personal allegiance.
Teacher / Minister / Steward	Master / Supreme Teacher	Defines accountable functions rather than human superiority.
claimed revelation	God has ordered everyone to...	Keeps the claim distinct from communal authority.
discernment	leader’s spiritual certainty	Makes testing and accountability explicit.

Prefer	Instead of	Why
former Companion / person who left	apostate / traitor / enemy	Protects exit and ordinary human relationships.
current teaching	eternal unquestionable doctrine	Allows confidence without manufactured certainty.
Board / Council with defined powers	the leadership	Forces institutional actors and jurisdictions to be named.

10. Organizational naming map

Thing being named	Working term	Status / next step
Religion / path	the Way	Adopt as native religious term; do not rely on it alone as legal brand.
Adherent	Companion / Companion of the Way	Adopt.
All adherents	the Companions	Adopt.
Religious community	the Assembly	Adopt as native communal term; public-brand clearance still needed.
Local congregation	House of Prayer	Adopt functionally; naming/clearance convention to be developed.
Inclusive ceremonial phrase	House of Prayer for All Peoples	Adopt as theological/ceremonial expression.
Research arm	Institute for Sacred Inquiry	Candidate; fits research better than whole-religion identity.
Nonprofit corporation	UNDECIDED Inc.	Must remain a distinctive clearable legal name; it need not equal the sacred vocabulary.
Website/public umbrella	UNDECIDED	Derive after legal/trademark/domain review.

11. Legal and governance translation rules

- A Companion is not a “member” within the Tennessee Nonprofit Corporation Act merely by being a Companion. If the corporation is formed without statutory members, religious membership terminology must not accidentally create statutory-member rights.
- The Assembly is not the Board of Directors. Religious discernment can inform corporate decisions, but fiduciary authority stays with the legally responsible body unless the charter/bylaws lawfully provide otherwise.
- A House of Prayer is not independently incorporated, authorized to contract, own property, employ staff, open bank accounts, or issue credentials merely because the religious community recognizes it. Those powers require written delegation or a separate legal entity.
- Minister, Teacher, Steward, and Elder titles confer only the authority written into their role descriptions. Spiritual language does not enlarge civil or financial authority.
- No claimed revelation or discernment can amend governing documents outside their lawful amendment procedures.

12. What this means for the eventual public/legal name

The sacred vocabulary no longer needs the legal corporation to carry every identity function. That gives us much more freedom when the name-clearance phase begins.

Promising legal-name formulas to test — not cleared names — include:

- The Assembly for All Peoples, Inc.
- The Assembly of Companions, Inc.
- Companions of the Way, Inc.
- [Distinctive Word] Assembly, Inc.
- [Distinctive Word] House / Assembly Foundation, Inc. (if a separate asset-holding or charitable entity ever becomes necessary).

Because “The Way” is already heavily used in American religious organizational names, the current recommendation is to keep it central in native religious speech while seeking a more distinctive legal and public-facing corporate identifier. Name clearance should include Tennessee corporate records, USPTO marks, major web search, domain/social availability, and confusion analysis before adoption.

13. Public-facing information architecture implied by the lexicon

- The Way — what the tradition teaches and practices
- Companions — belonging, rights, responsibilities, and how to participate
- The Assembly — the wider community, governance, councils, transparency
- Houses of Prayer — local communities and gatherings
- Prayer & Practice — worship, prayer, contemplation, retreats, shared practices
- Study & Inquiry — historical research, sacred sources, languages, publications
- Service — charitable assistance and community service
- Teachings — adopted teachings, confidence levels, dissent, revision history
- Governance & Integrity — participant rights, safeguarding, complaints, finances, founder limits

14. Recommended next work packet

The naming problem is now narrow enough to move from vocabulary into practice. The next packet should develop the lived religious grammar rather than invent more brand names.

1. Define the Companion relationship: visitor → participant → Companion, including an entirely voluntary Companion Commitment and a simple exit mechanism.
2. Design the House of Prayer model: minimum functions, gathering pattern, local stewardship, safeguarding, finances, and relationship to the central corporation.
3. Design the first forms of Gathering: Prayer, Study, Service, and communal fellowship without prematurely freezing a liturgy.
4. Determine ministry vocabulary and credentialing: Minister, Teacher, Steward, Elder, commissioning, and whether ordination is eventually needed.
5. Develop a theology-of-knowledge vocabulary around encounter, testimony, revelation, interpretation, teaching, doctrine, and uncertainty.
6. After those are coherent, run the distinctive legal/public name search. The corporate name should emerge from the lexicon but remain legally distinguishable from generic sacred terms.

Current recommended working sentence

We are Companions of the Way. Together we are the Assembly. We gather in Houses of Prayer for prayer, study, fellowship, discernment, and service — seeking truth without surrendering conscience.

Appendix A. Historical source notes

S1 — Paul Trebilco, “The Way – ἡ ὁδός,” in *Self-designations and Group Identity in the New Testament*, Cambridge University Press.

<https://www.cambridge.org/core/books/abs/selfdesignations-and-group-identity-in-the-new-testament/way/AEF12B21BC6680D51128DEB87906F6DB>

S2 — Encyclopedia.com, “Ṭarīqah,” on Arabic path/way and Sufi usage.

<https://www.encyclopedia.com/environment/encyclopedias-almanacs-transcripts-and-maps/tariqah>

S3 — Encyclopedia.com, “Eightfold Path,” on Buddhist mārga/magga as path of practice.

<https://www.encyclopedia.com/philosophy-and-religion/eastern-religions/buddhism/eightfold-path>

S4 — Shiromani Gurdwara Parbandhak Committee, “Panth,” describing panth as “the way” / good way of life and the Sikh community.

<https://sgpc.net/panth/>

S5 — Encyclopaedia Judaica via Encyclopedia.com, “Congregation (Assembly),” on qahal / edah and the assembly of Israel.

<https://www.encyclopedia.com/religion/encyclopedias-almanacs-transcripts-and-maps/congregation-assembly>

S6 — Encyclopedia.com, “Umma,” on Arabic umma as group/community and religious community.

<https://www.encyclopedia.com/philosophy-and-religion/eastern-religions/hinduism/umma>

S7 — Encyclopedia.com, “Saṅgha,” on Buddhist community.

<https://www.encyclopedia.com/religion/encyclopedias-almanacs-transcripts-and-maps/sagha>

S8 — The Concise Oxford Dictionary of World Religions via Encyclopedia.com, “Sangat,” on Sikh local congregation and Sikh Panth.

<https://www.encyclopedia.com/religion/dictionaries-thesauruses-pictures-and-press-releases/sangat>

S9 — Quaker.org glossary, on Friends, Meeting, meetinghouse, discernment, and related native Quaker vocabulary.

<https://quaker.org/glossary/>

S10 — The Concise Oxford Dictionary of World Religions via Encyclopedia.com, “Companions,” on the Islamic Ṣaḥāba.

<https://www.encyclopedia.com/religion/dictionaries-thesauruses-pictures-and-press-releases/companions>

S11 — American Heritage Dictionary, “companion,” etymology through Old French / Latin com- + panis (“bread”).

<https://ahdictionary.com/word/search.html?q=companion>

S12 — Isaiah 56:7, “house of prayer for all peoples,” with multiple English translations.

<https://www.biblegateway.com/verse/en/Isaiah%2056%3A7>

S13 — Encyclopedia.com, “Gurdwārā,” on the Sikh place where the sangat gathers.

<https://www.encyclopedia.com/philosophy-and-religion/eastern-religions/hinduism/gurdwara>

Appendix B. Status summary

ADOPT

The Way, Companion, Companions, The Assembly, House of Prayer, House of Prayer for All Peoples, Gathering, walking the Way, Encounter, Testimony, Witness, Interpretation, Teaching, Tradition, Inquiry, Discernment,

Prayer, Worship, Study, Service, Offering, Retreat, Founder, Teacher, Steward, Commissioning, Board of Directors

PROVISIONAL / CANDIDATE

Revelation, Sacred Sources, Remembrance, The Common Table, Rule of Life, Minister, Elder, Council, Council of the Assembly, Council of Houses, Regional Assembly, Companion Commitment, Institute for Sacred Inquiry, House of Study

RESERVED / CONTEXTUAL

Revelation, Doctrine, Scripture, Canon, Ordination, Clergy

AVOID / NOT AN OFFICE

Prophet, Master, Guru / Shaykh / Rabbi / Imam / Priest, Apostate / heretic / unbeliever, Follower of the Founder